

Art: Art, Craft and Design

(A Level, AQA)

This is a broad-based course exploring practical, critical and contextual work through a range of 2D and/or 3D processes and media. Our Art, Craft and Design A level gives you the skills and knowledge to create personal and imaginative work using a range of skills, processes and techniques.

Drawing is an important part of any art course and we start with a project over two terms that will give you the confidence to record observations using a range of drawing media and materials. There will be opportunities to learn new processes such as printing, painting, photography, and digital art. In term 2 you will be able to choose the direction and theme you want to take your work in for your first mini project, both contextually with art that inspires you and through the choice of media.

You must include at least two areas of specialism within the Unit 1 coursework project; Fine Art, Graphic Design and Illustration, Photography or 3D. Your teachers will guide you with finding the right direction for your work and how to use your strengths and interests. During Year 12 you will be introduced to these specialist areas through workshops including oil, watercolour and acrylic painting, printing and dry point etching, clay and 3D, photography and editing software, graphic design, computer software such as Illustrator and Photoshop, and illustration techniques. Your teachers have lots of experience and knowledge to share and advise you on your art journey.

The course is structured to support the understanding of the four assessment objectives, whilst giving you the freedom to experiment with ideas in depth. You will be expected to use four hours of time out of lessons a week to develop work and complete projects to meet deadlines.

Entry Requirements:

GCSE Grade 4 in Art. Good drawing skills are essential. If you have not taken Art and Design GCSE you will be expected to show work of the expected level before coming to the induction session and starting the course.

Course Content

Unit	%	When?	Content
Component 1: Personal Investigation	60%	September to December (Year 1)	Natural Form Project: You will be exploring the elements of art while exploring different media and processes, using natural forms as the starting point to the images. Line, tone, shape, form, texture, colour, space and composition. You will also be developing skills in portraits and figures. This will then lead into a more independent exploration during the second term, developing stronger skills with your chosen media and processes. Your choice of natural form.
		January (Year 1) to January (Year 2)	Personal Investigation: your choice of theme Inspiration Book – finding inspiration from a range of sources - learning how to research, analyse and respond to art, craft and design. Responding and experimenting with ideas – developing skills Trip to Art Galleries – recording experiences to inspire your own project. Essay – 1000-3000 word essay that makes links with your own art and shows critical and contextual understanding. Practical project resulting in final outcomes – you will start the main project in September of Year 2.
Component 2: Externally Set assignment	40%	February to May (Year 2)	Choose from eight given starting points from the exam board. Preparation work over three months to develop ideas. Fifteen hours (three days) of supervised sessions to complete your final outcomes. All work is assessed as a whole project for final grade.

Career Links

Students who have done Fine Art frequently go on to degree courses via an Art Foundation course and have ended up pursuing careers in Painting, Architecture, Art Therapy, Teaching, Theatre Design, Film and Media work, Sculpture, Graphic Design, Arts Administration and Gallery work. Some go directly on to degree courses in subjects like those above, but also Art History and combined courses.

For more information please contact Mrs J Lewis or Ms Wolfe